

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7
 ♥ 10 7 6 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♣	1 ♠	3 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
while you still have the ♣A for an entry.

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S5 N:S3]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, West played the ♠7 and North the ♠5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠6, ♠5, ♠4, ♠3 and ♠2. So the ♠7 is West's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

North held up with ♠A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦10 West will win the ♦A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out North's ♠A

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 3
 ♥ A J 3
 ♦ K 5 2
 ♣ K Q J 6 2

♠ J 7 5
 ♥ 10 7 6 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 3
 ♣ 7



♠ A 9 8
 ♥ K Q
 ♦ Q J 8
 ♣ 10 9 8 5 3

♠ K Q 10 4 2
 ♥ 9 8 5
 ♦ 10 9 7
 ♣ A 4

West	North	East	South
3♣	Pass	1♣	1♠
All Pass		3NT	
3NT by East			

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S8 N:S3]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, North played the ♠7 and East the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠4.

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that North has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out East's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and North will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

There IS another possibility if East is a better than average Declarer. North just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving East ♠ A J 8 5. East played the ♠8 as a falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate East for the fine play.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ 6 4
♦ J 7 3
♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ K J 8 3

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 4



♠ K 8 6 3

♥ Q 10

♦ 10 9 5 4 2

♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ A 9 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ 10 9 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
2 ♣	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

[showcards W:CA N:C4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣4

Play the ♣8 to encourage a continuation. West will play the ♣Q on which you will play the ♣2.

West now knows you started with a doubleton, and more importantly, he also knows you want him to play a third ♣.

When he next plays the ♣K dummy will ruff, but whatever card he ruffs with you will have established a trump trick. When you later win your ♠K that will be down 1.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 5
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ A 10 6
 ♣ Q 10 3

♠ 7 3

♥ J 8 4 3

♦ K J 9 5 2

♣ 8 2



♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K J 9 6 5

♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 10 9

♦ Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			

[showcards S:CQ]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, South wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. West holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that South holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If South is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it West's chance of making 9 tricks.